Supplementary

Homeless Man and his Friends: A true story

There is a homeless man in Rio do Sul in south Brazil who often sacrifices his own food to feed the stray dogs around him. Once he suddenly required emergency treatment, his kindness came back to him like a **boomerang**, for the faithful dogs he had been feeding made sure he wasn't alone.

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The dogs' **incredible** loyalty was witnessed by nurse Cris Mamprim and her colleagues. The homeless man, known as César, arrived at the emergency room of the hospital at about 3 A.M. to seek treatment and **medication** for a pre-existing health condition he had been battling. It was his first time at the hospital for treatment, as he normally goes to another health facility in town. Thus, Mamprim and her colleagues did not know about César's condition, nor his background.

But not before long, they realised that he had a gang of dogs accompanying him. Four concerned dogs had showed up at the entrance of the hospital and were waiting for César. They were concerned about their homeless master, who the nurses soon learned had been for some time forgoing his own meals to feed the dogs.

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